Lerato Munche

ICT & Digital Policy Professional

Profile

A passionate information communication technologies practitioner with academic qualifications spanning the disciplines of information technologies, social sciences, journalism, development studies and management as well as certifications in Agile, SCRUM, DNS, Internet Governance and policy writing as well as an additional 10 years of work experience including analytical work related to ICT's governance, digital policy-making, development management, participatory governance and related work within intergovernmental and not-for-profit spaces for digital transformation, inclusive innovation, diversity and inclusion.

I am competent in writing compelling plans, programs and curriculum drawing from marshaling resources from across the business and regions within which it operates to successfully deliver on revenue and strategy goals both within the society as well as within the market. My writing experience includes writing high level reports, meeting summaries and synthesizing information and inputs.

Within my historical experience framework I have also been responsible for project management, product management and coordination of internal and external resources for shareholders, stakeholders and third parties/vendors to ensure that projects and products are delivered in a timely manner, executed within scope and within budget. Part of my reference includes developing project scopes as well as objectives. This means involving all relevant stakeholders and ensuring that products and projects meet their technical feasibility. I am able to coordinate, manage and delegate responsibilities as well as to ensure delivery of product/project.

As a professional I am able to combine product planning and management of the product life-cycle of one specific product, working with engineering to define the vision and scope as well as overseeing the product strategy, pricing and positioning strategies; employing Agile Project Manager techniques to ensure the timely delivery of high-quality technical innovation solutions which drive the key business strategies. This allows me to lead across functional development teams through all phases of the product development process, from discovery through development and to product launch.

Within my capacity I am available to coordinate data, research and governance related tasks working with high profile stakeholder groups on policy, networks as well as meaningful access for the input of a substantive and diverse representation. I work with a determined development scope to ensure that I create and organize compelling relationships with partners and merchants towards company/project/product development, looking specifically at strategic alignments and integration of larger organizational strategies for the development of business, community development and market positioning.

I am highly skilled at not only looking after day-to-day operations of a company but have the acumen to lead visions and design strategies for a company. Reporting directly to the board of directors, investors and shareholders, I am able to lead and implement organizational changes within a company and remain accountable to the shareholders in a company.

Employment History

Chief Executive Officer at CodeForward Women in Tech, Durban

September 2023 – Present

As a CEO I am responsible for steering the organization and helping it evolve into a sustainable, front-tier non-profit in the area of primary education. I am hands-on in providing strategic leadership and have proven abilities in institu-

Details

Durban, South Africa
+27 82 555 0147
lerato.munche@example.com

Links

LinkedIn
Instagram
Website
Twitter

Skills

- Account Management
- Agile and Scrum
- IT Project Management
- Agile Project Management
- JavaScript
- Python
- HTML & CSS
- No-Code Development
- UX / UI
- Adobe Photoshop
- Graphic Design
- Copywriting
- Internet Governance
- Product Management
- Content Writing

Languages

- English
- French
- isiZulu
- Sesotho

tion building, fund raising, credibility enhancement and developing, managing and fostering stakeholder relationships.

Key Job Responsibilities:

1. **Leadership and Programme Management:**
   - Overall responsibility for formulating and developing a high-quality portfolio of programs, with emphasis on scaling-up innovative approaches in different areas such as technology, social mobilisation, local institution building, architecture of partnerships, management techniques etc.;
   - Developing and managing monitoring, evaluation and impact assessment activities for the organisation's programmes;
   - Developing and monitoring programme budgets;
   - Taking leadership and responsibility for managing resources engaged for programmes, with emphasis on team development and capacity building activities, as well as contributing to an encouraging, positive, flexible and professional working environment.
2. **Communication, Collaboration, and Partnership Development:**
   - Establishing and maintaining partnerships and constructive dialogues with stakeholders across the country, comprising Civil Society Organisations, State Governments, Private Sector and CSR Philanthropies, Donors, etc., with a view to enabling strategic collaborations to promote the organisation's work in education for young girls;
   - Promote local institution building and strengthening of community-based organisations.
3. **Fundraising and Resource Mobilisation:**
   - Directing resource mobilisation activities targeted at institutional, corporate and individual donors, to mobilise and ensure availability of funds for the different programmes and projects supported by the organisation;
   - Branding and positioning the organisation to effectively leverage the reach of its Board and partners to fund its projects and initiatives.
4. **Integration and Convergence:**
   - Working as a team player within the organisation to support other programmes and activities, promoting institutional goals and encouraging integration of ideas and disciplines within the organization and among partners;
   - Providing support to projects with a view to enabling convergence across various thematic areas of primary education in the region.
5. **Research, Policy Development, and Capacity Building:**
   - Providing intellectual leadership on identified research priorities;
   - Maintaining an active dialogue with partners and policy makers and contributing to bridging the gaps between research, policy, and practice.

Candidate Member of Parliament at New Dawn Alliance, South Africa

March 2023 – March 2026

New Dawn Alliance (NDA) is a South African political party launched in September 2022. The party contested the 2024 general election as an "umbrella organisation" for independent candidates.

My role in the party is that of a candidate member of Parliament. A member of parliament (MP) is the representative in parliament of the people who live in their electoral district.

Some of my responsibilities in this role included:

- Established a network of contacts and built relationships with potential candidates to increase the candidate pool.
- Increased member registrations to meet the 2 million voter target.
- Developed and maintained a database of members, with over 200,000 people signed up in KwaZulu-Natal.
- Trained and supervised a team of 7 staff members and 2 volunteers in the ward, ensuring each team member was performing to the highest standard.
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive candidate assessment program that improved the accuracy of regional representation.

Youth Internet Governance Track Coordinator at International Digital Policy Forum Secretariat, Geneva

February 2022 – November 2022

To further develop the Youth Strategy and continue engaging youth in forum processes, the Secretariat, together with the 2022 host country government and all youth coordinators, designed several capacity development activities implemented during the 2022 process, including at the annual flagship meeting. Close cooperation with a number of international youth-centric organizations was sought.

Specifically, the engagement activities had the following aims:

- Develop capacity on the overall concept of digitalization: look into opportunities and policy challenges it brings to policy shapers and makers.
- Establish networking among young people from around the world.
- Support cooperation among youth-focused initiatives involved or interested in Internet governance across the world.

Youth Internet Governance NRI Outreach at National Youth Digital Governance Forum, South Africa

May 2022

National and regional initiatives are organic, independent formations which discuss pertinent issues related to internet governance from the experience and perspectives of their respective regional communities. Much of the work which is done is local in context and includes organisation of multistakeholder participatory events towards the furtherment, protection and interoperability of the global forum. These act in accordance with the main principles of the global forum and are expected to follow the principles and practices of being open and transparent, inclusive and non-commercial. They work in accordance with the bottom-up consensus process and require multistakeholder participation (at least three stakeholder groups initially, evolving toward inclusion of all stakeholder groups), both in the formation of the initiative and in any other initiative-related events.

CEO – Founder at LaunchPad Africa, Durban

October 2020 – November 2022

LaunchPad Africa was set up to be an empowerment hub for Pan-African technology entrepreneurs, building a strong pipeline and community of entrepreneurs in Africa: a 12-week incubation pipeline program supported by industry mentors and access to seed funding, followed by a 1-year immersion program for the top 10 best innovation scale-ups and a 5-year support structure for high-impact ideas with scalability. The program is fully immersive and forms part of a greater conglomerate eco-system of startup founders, investors, industry experts and other key stakeholders.

At LaunchPad Africa we empower Pan-African entrepreneurs to leverage their skills to build strong technology startups from scratch, accelerating the transformation of project ideas and prototypes into validated business models ready for market investment. We build communities and alliances to aggregate further opportunities for entrepreneurs to maximise impact.

In my role here I was responsible for:

- The daily operations of the company, functioning as the executive head of the organisation.
- Working with heads of individual companies rather than the businesses as a whole.
- Keeping the company solvent to promote expansion and innovation.
- Researching and implementing new initiatives to drive revenue, lower operation costs and maintain the quality and integrity of the program, ensuring the company remains competitive.
- Customer client acquisition and driving customer support.
- Community and ecosystem development and pipeline creation through various intervention and innovation programs.
- Promoting talent acquisition.
- Preparation of annual reports and maintaining relations with the board of directors and various stakeholders and shareholders.
- Managing resources including attracting, hiring, and retention of personnel.

Skills learnt during this process:

- Managing a company; crisis management and conflict mediation skills.
- Leadership and problem solving; high level business awareness and acumen.
- Experience in managing staff, senior staff, employees and available resources.
- Financial management and organisational (company) management.

Public Relations and Communications Advisor at BridgeLine Communications, Durban

March 2021 – May 2021

Working with BridgeLine Communications I was tasked to promote and protect the brand ethos and reputation as well as to build the organisation brand across sectors. In practice this meant creating and supervising the company marketing collateral including press releases, external stakeholder communications and liaisons. The channels I selected for this company were the company website and social media, to communicate with internal and external clients about the company's products, news and

other developments. In this role, hard deliverable tasks included:

- Formulating PR plans and strategies.
- Enhancing the company's voice and presence through online and offline channels.
- Managing media relations and requests.
- Writing press releases, speeches and other PR copy.
- Planning and supervising events, fairs, conferences etc.
- Presenting solutions in times of PR crisis.
- Facilitating the resolution of disputes with the public or external vendors.
- Leading survey initiatives and analyzing public opinion.

Startup Act PMO Office Project Manager at MobiComm and EntreSA, Johannesburg

June 2021 – October 2021

EntreSA is a collaborative research, stakeholder engagement and policy design effort by key stakeholders from both the public and private sector, set out to amplify entrepreneurship and policy dialogues as well as the establishment and runway of a national Startup Act movement. Much of the work which I completed while here included planning projects to ensure they were completed in a timely fashion and within budget. This meant being able to determine and define project scope and objectives, coordinating the task team and stakeholders to define, predict and coordinate resources needed to reach objectives and manage resources. As the project manager I prepared budgets based on scope of work and resource requirements; managed contracts with vendors and suppliers by assigning tasks and communicating expected deliverables; utilized industry best practices, techniques, and standards throughout entire project execution; monitored progress and made adjustments as needed; and measured project performance to identify areas for improvement.

Host Site Liaison at SkillBridge, Durban

September 2020 – February 2021

In this job post I was responsible for coordinating and acting as the contact point for hosting and stakeholder clients. This meant keeping a good record of human collateral as well as maintaining programmatic dialogue between the client and the stakeholder relations as well as human capital.

Practically, the hard tasks and skills I was responsible for included hosting initial discussions with the host implementing partner to showcase the value proposition of the project and to build a successful project around the implementing partner's needs; managing relationships with line managers to ensure value add to the implementing partner; ensuring the professional development at the facilities of the host implementing partners; and working closely with line managers at worksites to empower them to provide the best on-the-job training and experience possible.

The hard skills learnt in this job role include:

- Aligning a project plan for each host implementing partner project, including the objectives of what the projects aim to achieve, as well as ensuring that any potential gaps in the project process are addressed efficiently and effectively.
- Reporting to the Head of Department.
- Managing the relationship with the host implementing partner from the beginning to the end of the staffing process.

Global Partnerships Manager at CodeForward, Durban

March 2019 – June 2023

In this position I was responsible for providing support in the implementation of robust strategic partnerships to promote the CodeForward brand and profile globally. In addition, my responsibility was to build strategic alliances and partnerships.

My responsibilities:

- Develop and support the implementation of the global partnership strategy to increase engagement of partners for Africa and internationally.
- Engage global partnership leads in developing and sharing strategic partnership models.
- Identify and build strategic alliances and partnerships to support the organisation's thought leadership agenda.
- Lead in acquisition, negotiation, and maintenance of private sector, foundation and bilateral donor partnerships for Africa.
- Drive global partner relationship management efforts to maintain and grow existing corporate and other partner relationships.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams to structure and execute partner initiatives.
- Build country office staff capacities and sensitization on private sector partnerships and resource mobilization.
- Identify business opportunities with prospective and new partners, including supporting the development of a resource mobilization plan.
- Ensure that corporate engagements, new and existing, transition to use enterprise products.
- Lead the annual continental innovation conference secretariat on behalf of the organisation, while managing and engaging

with key stakeholders.
- Serve as key resource staff for partnerships and participate in working groups.
- Develop work plans for strategic partnerships and initiate/lead forums to advance corporate priorities.
- Work with partners to ensure that their communications and joint programs/initiatives build the organisation's visibility and global presence.
- Build and strengthen the organisation's unique value proposition to partners.

Internal Communications at National Legislative Assembly, South Africa

September 2018 – February 2019

Marketing Coordinator at Cape Tech Collective, Durban

March 2016 – March 2017

In my role as the marketing coordinator at the Cape Tech Collective initiative, much of the work I completed was related to organisation of the board and the committee as well as coordinating and managing the greater technology eco-system across South Africa and globally, looking specifically towards assembling and analysing sales forecasts, marketing plans, objectives, planning and organising organisational promotional presentations (internally and externally), updating calendars, and preparing and organising marketing and advertising strategies.

The hard skills and tasks which I performed within this role include:

- Events planning & support.
- Assisting with social media accounts.
- Administrative assistance to the Board of Directors.
- Administrative assistance to the Committee Chairpersons.
- Budgeting at program level.

Overall, helping to oversee the successful completion of projects and events and other organisational tasks as well as managing a team of management and staff members. In this process I was further able to build relationships with vendors and freelance professionals, positioning the organisation and growing the reputational brand of the organisation.

Education

Master Public Relations and Communication, Cape Institute of Technology, Durban

February 2021 – 2023

In progress, specifically looking at positioning organisational relationships within multistakeholder ecosystems.

Post Graduate Diploma in Management Practice – Business Administration, Cape Atlantic University, Cape Town

June 2023 – November 2024

The Postgraduate Diploma in Management Practice is one of the most popular and sought-after programmes at the university's graduate school of business, with students and managers alike reporting its benefits to their organisations.

In this course I learnt how to:

- Develop crucial business skills needed to thrive in complex environments.
- Gain tools and techniques to be an efficient and effective manager.
- Learn to be a leader who inspires and adds value.

Baccalaureus Technologiae Journalism, Cape Institute of Technology, Durban

January 2019 – December 2019

I acquired a Baccalaureus Technologiae Journalism degree with specific emphasis on online media and content creation as well as political reporting, business reporting, mixed media design and layout.

DNS Practitioners Training Certificate, National DNS Practitioner Training Programme, Durban

June 2022

DNS Practitioner Training short course for 2022.

Project Manager Certificate, eLearn Academy, Online

January 2022 – June 2022

Project Manager Certificate.

Certified Professional: Java Application Developer, TechCert Institute, Online

January 2015 – December 2015

Professional level certificate.

Volunteer Services

Regional Ambassador at CodeLikeHer, San Francisco

January 2016 – January 2017

CodeLikeHer works to empower women to make their mark on technology. It is our belief that when everyone is equally represented in technology development, we are better able to accelerate innovation for those who need it the most. CodeLikeHer was a university's first conference on women in technology, reinventing technology for the next generation.

In this role I was responsible for organising a conference on women in technology, towards empowering and enabling women in technology to better reach their potential within the technology sector.

App Innovation Challenge Master Educator at BrightFuture STEM, San Jose

January 2016 – Present

The App Innovation Challenge is a mobile app development competition for girls to enter into technology through realistic application of technology skills. The challenge is to solve a problem in their community by building a mobile application and the surrounding business for it. The program starts at middle school level and later added primary school divisions. The final prize is USD 20,000 to start their business.

Youth Ambassadors Program 2022 at Global Internet Alliance, Online

July 2022

The Global Internet Alliance runs a Youth Ambassadors Program which takes place yearly. The fellowship took place online and is specifically related to building capacity through training and fostering a new cadre of young internet leaders who are motivated to act within their region and beyond. I was proud to join this program as a program mentor, coming in with my industry experience.

Global Internet Alliance – South Africa Chapter

May 2022 – Present

GIA Gender Standing Group

August 2022 – Present

GIA Affordability Access Special Interest Group

January 2022 – Present

Honors and Achievements

Woman of the Year Award, Inspire Girls Foundation *September 2019*

Top 50 Innovators Nominee, CoCreate Network *June 2021*

National Blog Awards, Best Science and Technology Blog *October 2017*

Women Lead Africa, Conference Ambassador *March 2017*

City Chamber of Commerce, Youth Startup Competition Winner *April 2019*

African Women's Innovation and Entrepreneurship Forum, Academy of Women Entrepreneurs *November 2020*

Internet Governance Experience

National Internet Chapter Board Member, Durban *2022 – 2023*

International Youth Internet Governance Coordinator, Geneva *2022 – 2023*

Global Internet Alliance Ambassador Program Mentor, GIA Global *2022 – 2023*

Africa Youth Digital Forum Coordinator, Lilongwe *2022 – 2023*

Africa Digital Governance Forum Coordinator, Africa NRI *2021 – 2023*

Generation Connect Global Youth Summit, Kigali *2022*

Regional Knowledge Network IGF, Nairobi *2022*

Regional Knowledge Network Youth IGF, Nairobi *2022*

World Summit on the Information Society, Djibouti *2022 – 2023*

Internet Corporation Annual Meeting, Virtual *2022*

Global Development Bank Youth Summit, Washington DC – Virtual *2022*

Group on Earth Observations, Accra *2022*

References

Dr. Amara Osei from International Digital Policy Forum
a.osei@example.org · +41 76 555 0132

Mr. Kofi Asante from National Information Technology Agency
k.asante@example.com · +233 20 555 0188

This document contains synthetic data created for demonstration purposes only.
All persons, organisations and contact details are fictitious.